INCH-POUND

A-A-20033B
September 27, 1995
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20033A
January 10, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TEA, BLACK (BAGS OR LOOSE)

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers black tea (bags or loose), packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The black tea shall comply to one of the following types, which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types.

Type I - Bags
Type II - Loose

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Dry leaf color: The black tea shall be fully fermented, dry, uniform in color, clean, and sound.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8955

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3.2 Dry leaf appearance: The black tea shall have a good appearance (including twist).

3.3 Leaf size: The leaf size for bag tea and loose black tea shall be pekoe (relatively small leaves), orange pekoe, broken pekoe, broken orange pekoe, broken tea, or a blend of these, but fannings or dust shall be excluded.

3.4 Dry tea aroma: The aroma from dry tea shall be sweet, fresh, and free from obnoxious or foreign odors.

3.5 Dry tea defects: The dry tea shall be and practically free from sticks, stems, and stalks.

3.6 Dry tea foreign material: The dry tea shall be free from foreign material (e.g.; metal; glass; evidence of insect, bird, and rodent contamination; etc.).

3.7 Infused leaf color and odor: The infused leaf shall be bright, uniform in color, and possess a sweet, fresh odor.

3.8 Prepared tea color: The prepared tea beverage shall have a color typical of that produced by black tea.

3.9 Prepared tea flavor: Black tea from recognized tea producing countries, either singularly or blended, shall produce a tea of pleasing flavor and shall be fully equal in cup quality when compared to the current Standard A-2 of the Tea Association of the United States of America.

3.10 Analytical requirements: For determination of excessive adulteration of black tea, any sample exceeding 1 percent extraneous material by weight, as indicated by USDA test results, shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3.10.1 Analytical procedure: One pound (0.454 kg) of composited tea shall be used for testing.

3.10.2 Analytical testing: Analyses shall be made in accordance with the following Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International method:

Test	Method
Heavy filth in tea	970.68

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4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered black tea shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the black tea in the commercial marketplace. Delivered black tea shall comply with all provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Contractor's certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the black tea offered meets the specified salient characteristics of this CID; and that the black tea conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same black tea offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The black tea shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

5.3 Product examination and examination for foreign material. The finished product shall be evaluated for conformance to the salient characteristics. The sample unit shall be 3 ounces (85.05 g) of tea extracted from 1 unit container, except for tea bags, in which case it shall be the number of tea bags from 1 container necessary to yield 3 ounces (85.05 g) of tea. Eight samples of 3 ounces (85.05 g) each shall be randomly selected from the lot and contents examined for conformance with requirements stated in the salient characteristics. The lot shall be rejected if one or more sample units fail to conform to the salient characteristics.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

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7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Type of product desired.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Sources of information for nongovernmental document are as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.**

Copies of the A-2 Standard may be obtained from: **The Tea Association of the United States of America, 230 Park Avenue, Suite 1460, New York, NY 10169.**

7.2.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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